

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

THE PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT OF 1995 (Pub. L. 104–13)

The purpose of this information collection is the application for CCDF funds and provides ACF and the public with a description of, and assurance about, the States' and Territories' child care programs. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 150 hours per response, including the time for reviewing instructions, gathering, and maintaining the data needed, and completing the form. This is a mandatory collection of information (Pub. L. 113–186), and 42 U.S.C. 9858.

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Arkansas

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:55:03 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

EQUAL ACCESS:AFFORDABILITY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide data on the extent to which CCDF providers charge families additional amounts above the required co-payment (including data on the size and frequency of such amounts), as required by 98.45(b)(5). (Plan Question 3.1.2eii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 05/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Arkansas launched a new eligibility system 12/4/2024. All CCDF providers are now required to acknowledge if they are charging families additional amounts above the required co-payment.	12/04/2025
2	Our IT department will also be updating the system to include the size and frequency of the amount.	05/30/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through July 31, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not pay based on enrollment or alternatively does not provide justification that this is impracticable or is not a generally-accepted practice, as required by 98.45(m)(2). (Plan Question 4.4.1b). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through July 31, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/31/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Arkansas launched a new eligibility system 12/4/2024.	12/04/2024
2	Arkansas plans to finalize new Prospective payment and pay by enrollment policies by May 2025.	05/30/2025
3	We are working with our IT department to update the payment practice process.	07/31/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i) . Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through July 31, 2026.
- The Lead Agency has until February 6, 2025, to submit general action steps and estimated timeline related to providing grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers and for children in underserved geographic areas using Appendix I of the 2025-2027 CCDF Plan.

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Award Notices sent to selected providers.	12/20/2024
2	Start-up funds issued to selected providers.	12/27/2024
3	Contract payments begin/serves begin.	01/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:POSTING INSPECTION REPORTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not post full monitoring and inspection reports that include all areas of compliance and non-compliance for all provider types, as required by 98.33(a)(4)(ii). (Plan Question 5.5.4a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for portions of this requirement through July 31, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/31/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Arkansas participated in a CCDF Monitoring and Inspection Report Peer Learning group.	11/29/2024
2	Identify and finalize desired system formatting.	07/31/2025
3	Full monitoring and inspection reports will be posted according to approved format and requirements.	07/31/2026